FAIRPLANE

Guided city tours

Based on ten customer interviews and observations from the Fairplane Guided City Tours team

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SCENARIO

Browsing, booking, attending, and rating a local city tour

Steps

What does the person (or group) typically experience?

Interactions

What interactions do they have at each step along the way?

People: Who do they see or talk to?

Places: Where are they?

Things: What digital touchpoints or physical objects would they use?

Goals & motivations

At each step, what is a person's primary goal or motivation? ("Help me..." or "Help me avoid...")

Positive moments

What steds does a typical person find enjoyable, productive, fun, motivating, delightful, or exciting?

Negative moments

What steps does a typical person find frustrating, confusing, angering, costly, or time-consuming?

Areas of opportunity

How might we make each step better? What ideas do we have? What have others suggested?

Entice

How does someone initially become aware of this process?

Choose a city,

booked
Visit website or app

Booking other travel

If you don't follow this path immediately after your booking, could we send a follow-up?

dates, and number of people

A customer navigates to the city tours section of our website or app

Most customers discover city tours as they are booking other Fairplane travel

City tours section of the website, iOS app, or Android app

Travel booking section of the website, iOS app, or Android app

Help me get this flight or hotel

Help me have more fun or learn new things on my trip

People sometimes forget to put in their dates or number of people, which leads them to discover tours they can't actually attend

Could we automatically carry over the city from your booking? (e.g. via a cookie)

Browse available tours

The customer types a city, dates, and the number of people who will attend the tour to see what tours are available

The customer sees available tours for their dates, city, and number of people

City tours section of the website, iOS app, or Android app

City tours section of the website, iOS app, or Android app

Help me avoid seeing tours for the wrong dates, locations, or numbers of people

Help me see what they have to offer

It's fun to look at options and imagine doing each tour, like shopping for experiences

Several people expressed "information overload" as they browse

Make it easier to compare and shop for experiences without having to click on them

View detail on a single tour

After seeing a tour that interests them, the customer clicks or taps to view more. They see information about what and where the tour will cover, plus its price, time of day, and tour guide.

City tours section of the website, iOS app, or Android app

The tour guide makes first appearance at this point, although the customer doesn't interact with them yet.

Help me understand what this tour is all about

Enter

What do people experience as they begin the process?

Tour photos, videos, and explanations are exciting to see

It's reassuring to red reviews written by past travelers

People express a bit of fear of commitment at this step

Excitement about the purchase ("Here we go!")

Trepidation about the purchase ("I hope this will be worth it!")

Complete payment information

They fill out their contact and credit card information, then continue

Provide a simpler summary to avoid information overload

Show highlights or common phrases from reviews, or Uber style "great guide" badges?

Start purchase of a tour

After deciding to go on this tour, they click the Purchase button

City tours section of the website, iOS app, or Android app

Help me get through this payment part without too much hassle

Help me commit to going on this tour

Payment overlay within the website, iOS app, or Android app

Help me feel confident that my purchase is finalized and tell me what to do next

Email confirmation

An email immediately sends to confirm their tour and provide details about where and when to meet their guide

Payment overlay within the website, iOS app, or Android app

Customer's email (software like Outlook or website like Gmail)

Help me feel confident that my purchase is finalized and tell me what to do next

Email reminder

One day before the tour begins, a reminder email is sent to all tour participants. The email emphasizes where and when to meet, and what to bring (if applicable).

Current payment flow is very bare bones and simple

Confirm payment & book tour

They see a summary of what they are about to purchase, then they confirm and the tour is booked!

Customer's email (software like Outlook or website like Gmail)

Engage

In the core moments in the process, what happens?

Help me make sure I don't forget about my tour so that I don't waste money or get disappointed

We've heard from several people that the reminder emails were essential, especially if they booked way in advance

Arrive at tour location

Using their own means of transportation, the customer makes their way to the tour location at the scheduled time.

Tour locations tend to start in a specific public space (e.g. the steps of a statue in a town square)

The customer looks for the group or guide, often from a distance as they walk closer

Help me feel confident about where to go and which one of these people is my guide

Help me feel good about my decision to go on this tour and to feel welcome

Our guides tend to be so good that people are reassured when they meet their guide

People expressed awkwardness about finding their guide in a public place

How might we make our guides easily identifiable (via a distinctive hat or shirt color, for example)?

Meet the guide & group

Tour participants meet the guide and other people who have joined the same tour

Direct interactions with the guide, and potentially other group members

People love the tour itself, we have a 98% satisfaction rating

Leave the guide & group

The guide wraps up the tour and everyone heads their separate ways

Direct interactions with the guide, and potentially other group members

Often takes place at the same place where the group met the guide, but not always

Depending on the tour participant and guide, tipping/cash may be involved

Help me leave the tour with good

Sometimes people are matched up with tour participants that they don't really like

Experience the tour

The guide brings the group around the area, explaining things as they go. Typically this lasts about 3 hours.

Direct interactions with the guide, and potentially other group members

Some tours include interactions with shopkeepers or restaurant staff (e.g. on a food-oriented tour)

Most common objects people interact with on tours are bikes, Segways, food, and beverages.

feelings and no awkwardness

Help me make the most of my trip to this new place

People generally leave tours feeling refreshed and inspired

People are unclear whether a tip is necessary, especially for non-Americans on an American tour

People feel peer pressure to tip a guide when someone else on the tour tips, leaving them feeling weird and bad if they don't

How might we make it clear that tipping is appreciated but not necessary?

How might we equip people to tip after the tour? (e.g. via Venmo or equivalent app)

How might we totally eliminate this awkward moment?

Exit

What do people typically experience as the process finishes?

Prompt for review

One hour after the tour finishes, an email and in app notification prompt the tour participant for a review

Customer's email (software like Outlook or website like Gmail)

Customers report feeling fatigue

We have very low review rates (15% of people review experiences and tours)

Could we A/B test different language to see what changes response rates?

submitting review

The tour participant writes a review and gives the tour a star rating out of 5.

Writing &

"Leave a review" modal window within the profile on the website, iOS app, or Android app

To some degree, this is communicating indirectly with the tour guide, who will see their review

Help me spread the word about a great tour or provide watch-outs and feedback for one that was not so good

People describe leaving a review as an arduous process

How might we progressively disclose the full review so that each step feels more simple?

Tour appears in the user profile

The completed tour appears on the "past experiences" area of a customer's profile with a few details on where the group went

Completed experiences section of the profile on the website, iOS app, or Android app

If other users interact with this person, they will see these completed tours also

Help me see what I've done before

Help me see what I could be doing next

Personalized tour offers

The customer receives an email 14 days after their tour with personalized recommendations for other tours

People like looking back on their past trips

Customer's email (software like Outlook or website like Gmail)

tour suggestions after new travel booking

When a past tour participant books new travel with us, we show them personalized tour recommendations in their arrival city.

Post-purchase screens website, iOS app, or Android app

How might we help people celebrate and remember things they've done in the past?

How might we extend the personal connection to the guide long after the tour is over?

Personalized recommendations

Participation in the tour informs our backend recommendation systems, which the customer may experience via better personalization

Recommendations span across website, iOS app, or Android app

We think people like these recommendations because they have an extremely high engagement rate

Help me see ways to enhance my new trip

Extend

What happens after the experience is over?

Personalized